



NATIONAL WATER RESOURCES MANAGEMENT AGENCY

APPLICATION FOR WATER RIGHT PERMIT

Please read the following prior to completing the application form.

Pursuant to the National Water Resources Management Agency Act No.5 of 2017, no person shall divert, dam, store, dredge, abstract or otherwise use water resources or construct or maintain any works for the use of water resources prior to obtaining a water right permit.

In order for the **NWRMA** to process applications for water rights conveniently, it is important that you complete the form as detailed as possible and include all the relevant documents. Applications will not be processed unless all required information is included.

1. Applications shall include:

- (a) A site plan, showing the different components of the proposed infrastructure of the project, such as intake structure, dams, weirs, ponds, pipelines, treatment facilities, industrial processing plant, effluent point and water meters.
- (b) A general description of the project entailing water use, including types of works, what the water will be used for and how, proposed production or results of project, proposed project start and completion dates.
- (c) Relevant documents such as Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA), Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) and other relevant permit from the Environmental Protection Agency, National Minerals Agency, Ministry of Energy, Local Councils, etc. If these have not yet been issued, state when application has been submitted and expected approval date. An environmental permit is required for projects subject to EPA regulations before a Water Use Permit may be issued.



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(d) A Water Demand Management Plan (WDMP) (preliminary): A WDMP shall include planned measures to reduce consumption and to monitor water use (metering). A WDMP is only required for consumptive uses, such as water abstraction.

(e) Business Particulars: Including registration, object of the company, representatives, and whether the company is currently under litigation for reasons pertaining to environmental pollution. (This applies to private businesses only).

2. Fill out the questionnaire as detailed as possible. Where attached sheets and other technical documents are used in lieu of the space provided, indicate appropriate cross-references. Paragraphs that are not applicable to your application should be marked as “N/A”.

3. Administrative and Processing Fees

The administrative fee covers costs of verification of site information and internal administration processing. Administrative fees of **Twenty Thousand New Leones (SLL 20,000.00) for provincial and One Thousand New Leones (SLL 1,000.00) for Western Area, Makeni and Bo Cities** for processing applications shall be paid on submission of a completed application for Water Use Permit.

Cash, certified cheques, and bank drafts are payable to the **National Water Resources Management Agency and the pay-in-slip is attached when submitting the filled application form.**

Account Name: National Water Resources Management Agency (SLL)

Bank Name: Bank of Sierra Leone

Account Number: 0111004067

BBAN Acct No: 000001011100406701

The administrative fee is non-refundable.

Applications will be processed **ONLY AFTER** the administrative fee has been paid.

Kindly note that the cost of the administrative and processing fee is different from the water use charge, which will be determined based on the water use.

4. Time required for processing.

On the precondition that the application has been completed correctly, the average length of time required to decide on permits is within 3 months from date of receipt, including if necessary, a public disclosure. (Delays may occur due to the processing of the environmental permitting and other permits where WDMP

**National Water Resources Management Agency
29 Kingharman Road, Brookfields, Freetown
Sierra Leone**



is not included in the EIA or ESMP)

5. Involvement in permit processing

The applicant is required to be present during the site verification exercise of the project area. The applicant will be informed of any objections raised during the hearing phase and of any information that the NWRMA receives from other parties. The applicant will be requested to participate in any public forums disclosure relating to the application.

6. Definitions of some water uses

- i. Consumptive Use: Using any mechanical means to withdraw water from ponds, lakes, rivers, streams, or aquifers, dams/reservoirs, etc. for purposes such as mining, irrigation, aquaculture (pond and hatchery), construction, etc.
- ii. Non-Consumptive Use: A water use that does not affect the quantity of freshwater. Water for purposes such as hydropower, boating, aquaculture (cage)
- iii. Municipal Use: Freshwater for municipal potable water supply to a population of more than 2000
- iv. Domestic Use: Freshwater water for household use.
- v. Small Town Domestic Water System: Freshwater for a small urban community with population between 2,000 and 30,000.
- vi. Industrial: Freshwater for industrial purposes, e.g. food processing, textile making
- vii. Commercial: Direct sale of freshwater for profit e.g. water tanker services
- viii. Dewatering (e.g. pit-dewatering, discharge): An intentional lowering of water level e.g. groundwater level,
- ix. Spillage (controlled): Controlled release of freshwater and/or effluent into the water body

If you are in doubt of any provision of the application form, please consult the **NWRMA** Secretariat on the contacts below. Applications may be delivered in person at the **NWRMA** address below:

Head Office

The Director-General
29 King Harman Road
Freetown
Sierra Leone

National Water Resources Management Agency
29 Kingharman Road, Brookfields, Freetown
Sierra Leone



Mobile: +23275 597184/+23230 775898

NATIONAL WATER RESOURCES MANAGEMENT AGENCY

Water Rights Application Form

1.0 Applicant Details:

Name of company/organization: _____
Name of CEO/Director: _____
Name of contact person(s): _____
Mailing address: _____

Telephone (Office): _____ Mobile: _____

Fax: _____ E-mail: _____ Website: _____

Permit: New ☐ Renewal ☐

Renewal: If renewal, state Permit ID number:

1.1. Ownership Information:

Cooperation ☐ Partnership* ☐ Joint Venture ☐ Sole Proprietorship ☐

Others (Please specify) *Please provide names, addresses and telephone numbers of all partners

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ _____

2.0 Location of the Water Use Activity:

Name of Town: _____ District: _____ Region: _____

Indicate type of (proposed) water use: Consumptive ☐ Non-consumptive ☐

3.0 Purpose/type of the water use:

Industrial ☐ Hydropower ☐



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Mining	☐	Small Town Domestic Water System	☐
Irrigation	☐	Commercial	☐
Domestic/Municipal	☐	Construction	☐
Recreation	☐	Damming	☐
Dewatering	☐	Aquaculture-Hatchery	☐
Navigation	☐	Diversion	☐
Aquaculture-Cage	☐	Wood Harvesting	☐
Water Tankering	☐		
Aquaculture-Pond	☐		
Spillage (freshwater)	☐		

Others (Please specify) -----

4.0 Indicate whether the following are included:

Environmental Impact Assessment Report	Yes	☐	No	☐
Environmental Permit & Schedule	Yes	☐	No	☐
Other relevant permits /licenses/letters from MDAs, etc.	Yes	☐	No	☐
Site Plan	Yes	☐	No	☐
Water Demand Management Plan (for consumptive uses only)	Yes	☐	No	☐
Business Certificates (for private establishments)	Yes	☐	No	☐

If the answer to the above is **No**, state reasons why and when full documentation can be expected

5.0 Data on the (proposed) water use:

Point of water use¹:

Name of Town District Region.....



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(Pls. state GPS co-ordinates)

Current status of the Water Use Activity: Construction/Installation Phase ☐ Operational Phase ☐

Date of Commencement of Activity if in Operation.....

Type of water source affected (e.g. River, Lake, Groundwater etc.)

Name of the water source affected² (if applicable)

Tributary of.....

In case of groundwater abstraction, indicate number of boreholes involved and GPS locations (attach additional sheet if necessary

.....

Rate of use (m^3/annum) being applied for.....

If water use activity is in progress, state actual rate of use (m^3/day)

Indicate any variations in rate of use: Daily: seasonal/monthly.....

Please indicate method of determining consumption/rate of use.....

6.0 Data on discharges or return flows:

Where water is discharged or returned to the natural environment, please state:

Location of discharge or return flow:

Name of Town..... District..... Region.....

Point of discharge or return flow (GPS co-ordinates):

Quantity of return flow (m^3/day)

Type of water body receiving discharge or return flow.....

Name of the water body receiving the discharge (if applicable) Quality
of return flow (attach freshwater/effluent quality monitoring results)

Please indicate method(s) of assessing water quality.....

Please indicate name of water quality testing institution(s): Projected duration
of use: from..... to.....



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1. Use is defined in the NWRMA Act, 2017 as to divert, dam, store, abstract or use water resources
2. Indicate the river, lake, reservoir or aquifer.

7.0 Project Description (Provide a detailed description of your project, including but not limited to type of construction activity, area to be graded or excavated, and how the water will be used. Attach extra sheet if necessary.)

8.0 Information on affected parties

Date of acquisition of interest or right of access

Beneficiaries of (proposed) water use activity:

Names of other major users (companies and communities) whose activities depend on the same water body/bodies or aquifer system mentioned above: (attach list)

Persons or areas affected by:

1) The (proposed) use of water: Up-stream.....

Down-stream

2) Subsequent discharges: Down-stream.....

Indicate any major impacts the proposed water use activity will have on the environment:

What measures are proposed or undertaken to avoid pollution, flooding or other adverse effects?



Data on Specific Water Use Activities

Additional data is required for certain specific uses. Please provide information as applicable below.

9.0 Abstraction (For all consumptive uses):

- Names and models of pumps:
- Pumping/Withdrawal mechanism:
- Number of pumps installed:
- Capacity of pumps:
- Capacity of additional pumps (to be installed):
- Pumping hours per day:
- Rate of abstraction (per hour) ($\text{m}^3/\text{hr.}$):

10.0 Aquaculture

10.1. Cage:

Proposed concession area (m^2):

Number of Cages:

Dimensions of Cages (m):

GPS coordinates of Proposed Concession Area Species to be cultivated:

10.2. Pond:

Number of ponds:

Dimensions of ponds (m):

Frequency of effluent discharge from ponds:

Discharge from ponds (m^3/min):

Type of effluent treatment system in place (attach extra sheet if necessary):

10.3. Tank:

Number of tanks:

Volume of tanks (m^3):

Frequency of discharge of tanks:

Discharge from tanks (m^3/min):

Type of effluent treatment system in place (attach extra sheet if necessary):



11.0 Municipal and Domestic Use/Small Town Domestic Water Supply.

The projected number of persons, establishments and institutions to be served (5, 10- and 20-year estimates.): Indicate the planned rate of use per capita (5, 10- and 20-year estimates)

Location

Particulars of distribution of water:

12.0 Irrigation

The Size of land to be irrigated (ha):

proposed water demand per hectare:

The types of crops to be irrigated:

Crop water demand (l/ha):

Type of irrigation system:

The type of soil to be irrigated:

Describe any works to drain irrigated land:

13.0 Hydropower Generation

The gross head available for power production at low, medium and high water level:

Operational head (max and min):

Power (to be) generated (MW):

Water release for power generation per day (m³/day):

System of mandatory releases (spillways etc.):

Comprehensive hydrological assessment (high & low flows):

14.0 Livestock Watering

Type (s) of livestock:

Maximum number of Livestock:

Water use per day per livestock (liters):

15.0 Navigation/Transport

Type of vessel:

Number of vessels:

Route of transport:

Distance travelled:

Engine capacity (horsepower):

Data on Specific Water Use activities



16.0 Diversion:

Indicate whether diversion is permanent or temporary:

Diversion by gravitation, canal or pipe:

Include detailed map/diagram of diversion works including dimensions and GPS coordinates:

Length, width and area of the portion of water body to be diverted:

Details of diversion plan/works including time frames:

Description of vegetation to be removed and/or planted before and after diversion:

Details of land ownership, if other than applicant:

17.0 Damming:

Height/proposed height of dam:

Length of dam (m):

Freeboard:

Type of construction material:

Maximum capacity of reservoir:

Area of inundation:

Average depth of storage:

System of mandatory releases (spillways etc.):

Type of spillway:

Details of damming works including time frames:

18.0 Recreation:

Type of recreational activity (e.g. boating, kayaking etc.):

Number of vessels:

Name & model of vessel/engine:

Capacity of engine (horse power):

19.0 Underwater Wood Harvesting:

Type of wood to be harvested:

Proposed concession area:

Harvesting equipment:

Harvesting time-frame:

20.0 Spillage (freshwater/effluent):

Rate of spillage (m³/sec):

Possible area of inundation:

Quality of spillage (attach water quality monitoring results):

Ecosystem affected e.g. vegetation:

21.0 Water Tankering/ Dust Suppression:

Number of Water tanks:

Volume of tanks (m³):

Frequency of water tankering/ dust suppression:



Data on Specific Water Use activities

22.0 Dredging:

Purpose of dredging:

Type & capacity of dredging machine:

Type and quality of material to be dredged:

Depth of dredging works:

Proposed dredging area:

Include detailed map/diagram of dredging activity:

23.0 Construction:

Type of construction works:

Status of construction:

partially ☐

proposed ☐

complete ☐

Proposed quantity of water to be used ☐

Commencement date:..... Completion date:.....

24.0 Dewatering:

Type of dewatering activity (e.g. pit, sump, etc....):

Purpose of dewatering:

Rate of dewatering:

Quality of water:

Duration of dewatering:

The information contained in this application is true to the best of my knowledge, information and belief.

Signature_____ Date_____Print name: _____



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OFFICE USE ONLY

Application No. _____ Date Rec.: _____ Fee rec. _____ : Receipt No.: _____ I.D No.: _____
Approved ☐ Disapproved ☐ Issue date: _____ Expiry date _____
